Practice workbook · Reconstructive memory and the War of the Ghosts

Bartlett's schema-based theory of reconstructive memory and his War of the Ghosts study.

10 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 9 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-MEM-05

1. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

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9 Leah is six years old and is in the park with her mum. She sees a small dog approaching her. The dog does not bark, but jumps up at Leah. Leah pulls her hands away from the dog but does not cry.

Later that day, Leah's dad asks her what happened at the park. She says that a large dog barked at her which made her cry.

(a) Explain why Leah's memory of the event at the park could have changed.

You should refer to the Theory of Reconstructive Memory in your answer.

(2)

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1. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **two** weaknesses with using the Theory of Reconstructive Memory to account for Leah's memory of the event with the dog at the park.

(4)

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(Total for Question 9 = 6 marks)

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Working and answer

2. Question 7 · part whole · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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7 Bamboo saw a man dressed in blue enter a shop and commit a robbery.

When asked by the police later, Bamboo said the man was dressed in black.

Explain why Bamboo's memory of the event could have changed.

You should refer to the Theory of Reconstructive Memory in your answer.

(Total for Question 7 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 5 · part a · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

5 (a) Identify the number of participants who took part in Bartlett's (1932) repeated reproduction of a Native American story called 'The War of the Ghosts'.

(1)

- ☒ **A** 10
- ☒ **B** 15
- ☒ **C** 20
- ☒ **D** 25

(b) State **two** findings of Bartlett's (1932) study using a repeated reproduction of a Native American story called 'The War of the Ghosts'.

(2)

Finding 1

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Finding 2

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(Total for Question 5 = 3 marks)

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Working and answer

4. Question 5 · part b · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

5 (a) Identify the number of participants who took part in Bartlett's (1932) repeated reproduction of a Native American story called 'The War of the Ghosts'.

(1)

- ☒ **A** 10
- ☒ **B** 15
- ☒ **C** 20
- ☒ **D** 25

(b) State **two** findings of Bartlett's (1932) study using a repeated reproduction of a Native American story called 'The War of the Ghosts'.

(2)

Finding 1

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Finding 2

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(Total for Question 5 = 3 marks)

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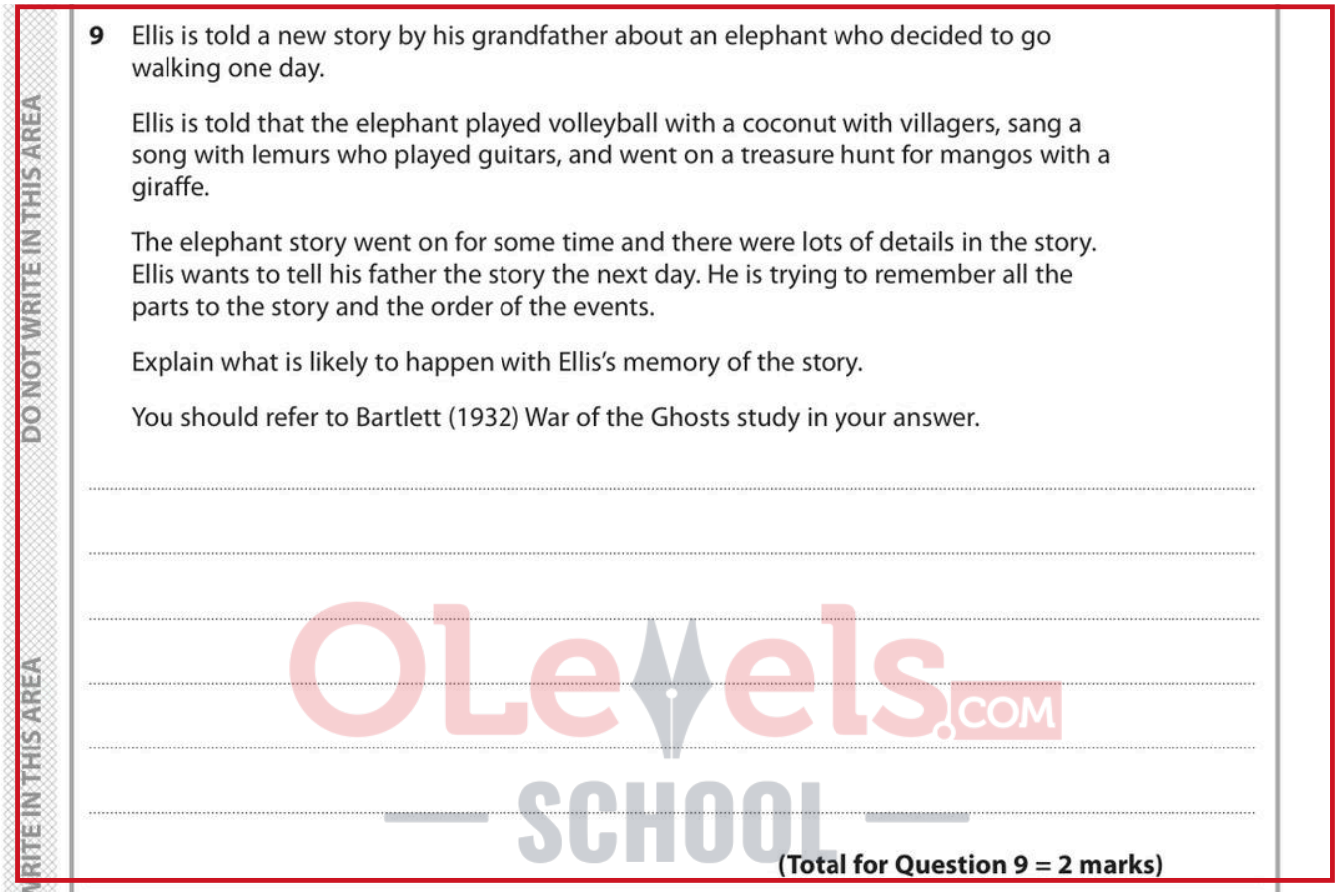
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Working and answer

5. Question 9 · part whole · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



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9 Ellis is told a new story by his grandfather about an elephant who decided to go walking one day.

Ellis is told that the elephant played volleyball with a coconut with villagers, sang a song with lemurs who played guitars, and went on a treasure hunt for mangos with a giraffe.

The elephant story went on for some time and there were lots of details in the story. Ellis wants to tell his father the story the next day. He is trying to remember all the parts to the story and the order of the events.

Explain what is likely to happen with Ellis's memory of the story.

You should refer to Bartlett (1932) War of the Ghosts study in your answer.

(Total for Question 9 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

6. Question 10 · part whole · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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10 Dries was investigating whether humans process information in an active or a passive way. He gave participants a paragraph where the words had the correct first and last letter but all the rest in the middle were jumbled. Participants had to say whether they could read the paragraph or not.

Dries considered information processing to be active if the participants could read the paragraph but passive if they could not read the paragraph.

The results are shown in **Table 2**.

Condition	Percentage (%)
Participants who could read the paragraph	98%
Participants who could not read the paragraph	2%

Table 2

Explain **one** conclusion that could be made from **Table 2** regarding how humans process information.

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(Total for Question 10 = 2 marks)

6. Question 10 · part whole · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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7. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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9 Leah is six years old and is in the park with her mum. She sees a small dog approaching her. The dog does not bark, but jumps up at Leah. Leah pulls her hands away from the dog but does not cry.

Later that day, Leah's dad asks her what happened at the park. She says that a large dog barked at her which made her cry.

(a) Explain why Leah's memory of the event at the park could have changed.

You should refer to the Theory of Reconstructive Memory in your answer.

(2)

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7. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(b) Explain **two** weaknesses with using the Theory of Reconstructive Memory to account for Leah's memory of the event with the dog at the park.

(4)

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(Total for Question 9 = 6 marks)

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7. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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8. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

9 Simon is investigating the memory of his students. He shows his students 6 words for 15 seconds as a group. Simon removes the words and asks his students to try and remember them.

After 30 minutes, Simon asks his students to try and recall the words.

Simon's word list is shown in **Figure 1**.

Acid	Unripe	Lemon
Bitter	Sharp	Tart

Figure 1

Simon finds that some of his students recalled the word 'sour' as part of their list of words.

(a) Explain why some of the students have recalled the word 'sour' when recalling the word list.

You should refer to the Theory of Reconstructive Memory in your answer.

(2)

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8. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Simon's investigation.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 9 = 6 marks)

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8. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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9. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

9 Megan was interested in investigating participants' memory of a story.

Megan went into a school in Japan and asked the children to read an unfamiliar story about a sea adventure that included unknown names, contained unusual content and had 330 words.

The children were asked to read the story twice and were then asked to try to reproduce the story the next day at school by writing it out on a piece of paper. They were then asked to try to recall the story once every six weeks, over a 24-week period.

The results of Megan's investigation are shown in **Table 1**.

Reproduction	Average number of words accurately recalled	Average number of errors compared to original story
The next day	180	5
After 6 weeks	120	8
After 12 weeks	80	10
After 18 weeks	50	14
After 24 weeks	30	18

Table 1

(a) Explain **one** conclusion that Megan could make using the data in **Table 1**.

(2)

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P 7 8 7 7 2 A 0 1 4 4 0

9. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Bartlett's (1932) War of the Ghosts study to account for the findings of Megan's investigation.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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(Total for Question 9 = 6 marks)

9. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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10. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

9 Megan was interested in investigating participants' memory of a story.

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P 7 8 7 7 2 A 0 1 4 4 0

10. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Bartlett's (1932) War of the Ghosts study to account for the findings of Megan's investigation.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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(Total for Question 9 = 6 marks)

10. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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